Japan's three kinds of hanko



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Three seals, three jobs



実印
Jitsuin

Registered at
City office

Used for
Property, cars, major contracts



銀行印
Ginkō-in

Registered at
Your bank

Used for
Bank accounts and transactions

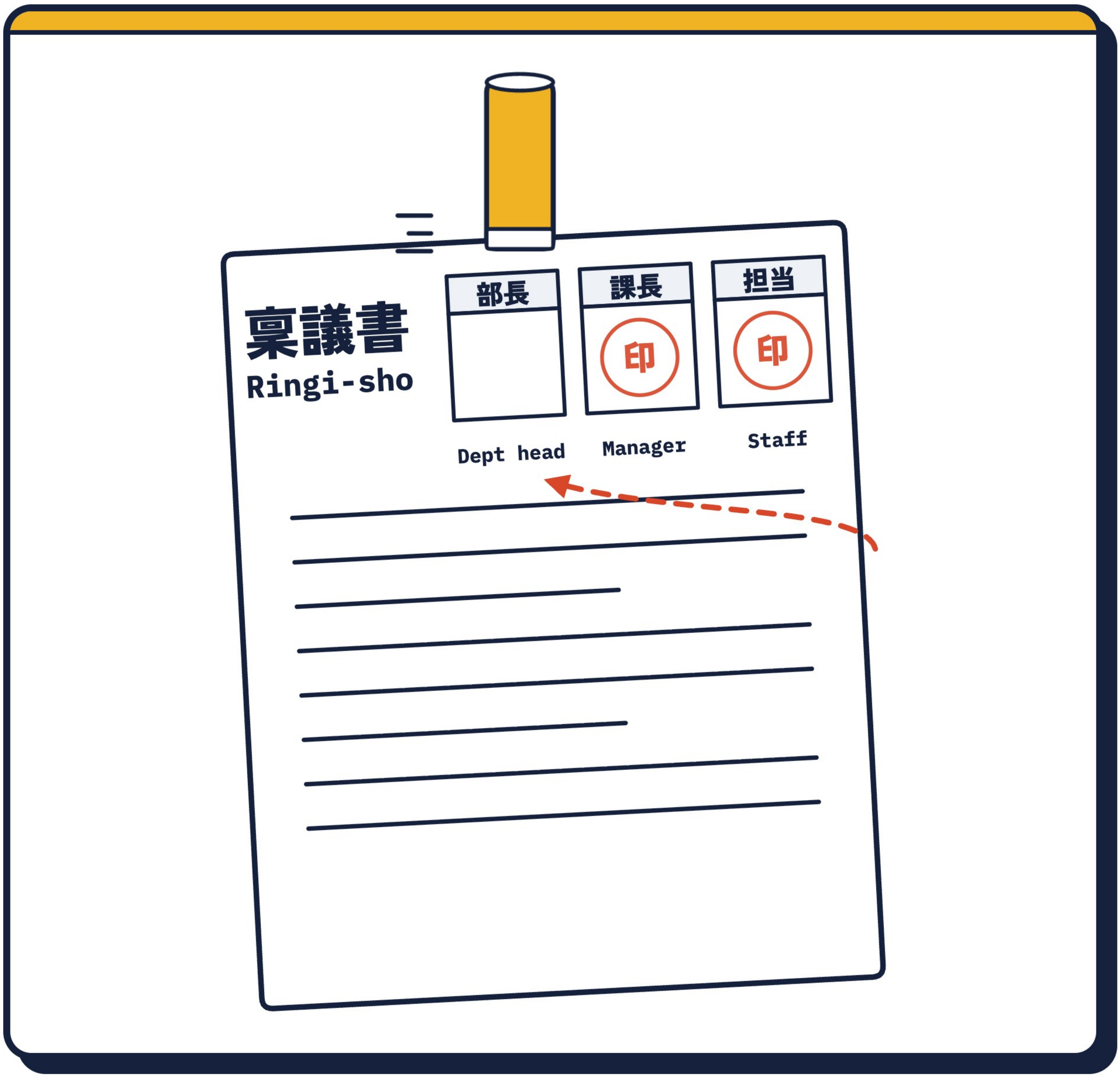


認印
Mitome-in

Registered at
Not registered

Used for
Deliveries, internal forms

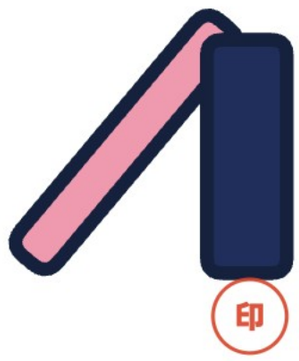
Approval, one stamp at a time



What changed







2020

Seal rules dropped for most government procedures

2021

The Digital Agency launches

Now

E-signatures are common. Registered seals still matter

Setting up in Japan



Ask early — Which documents need a registered seal

Allow time — Registration and certificates take a visit

Expect paper — Some partners still approve internally by stamp

Ask which documents still need a seal before you assume.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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